

Information Protection from the Field

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Speakers



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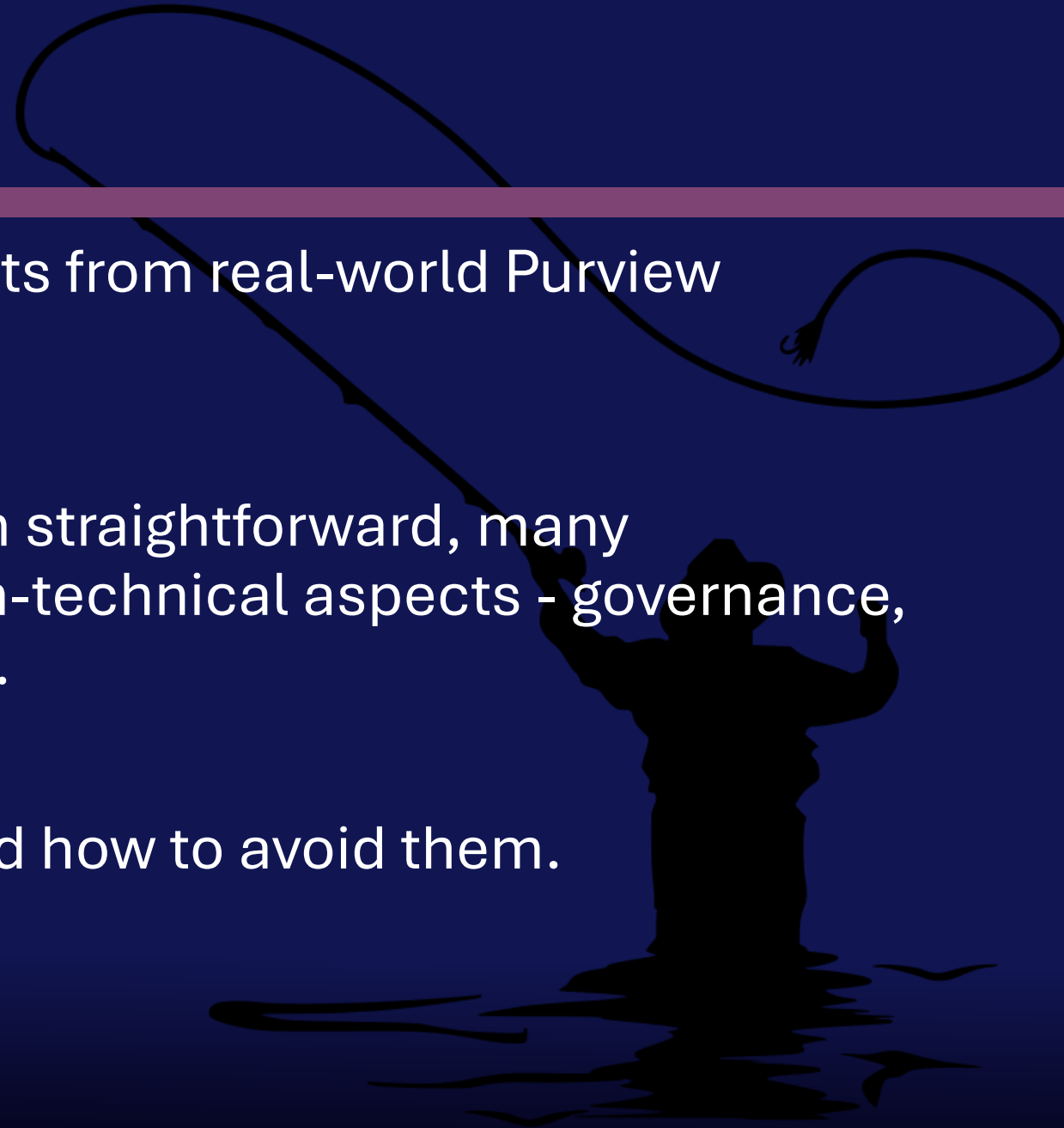


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Can't see our slides? Can't hear? Need to repeat the question? Call us out!

Overview

- ◆ We want to share practical insights from real-world Purview implementations.
- ◆ While the technical setup is often straightforward, many organizations stumble on the non-technical aspects - governance, adoption, and cultural alignment.
- ◆ We'll explore common pitfalls and how to avoid them.



Zero trust for Data

Verify Explicitly

- Data discovery & classification: Automatically scans and labels sensitive data
- Audit trails: Tracks who accessed what, when, and how

Least Privilege Access

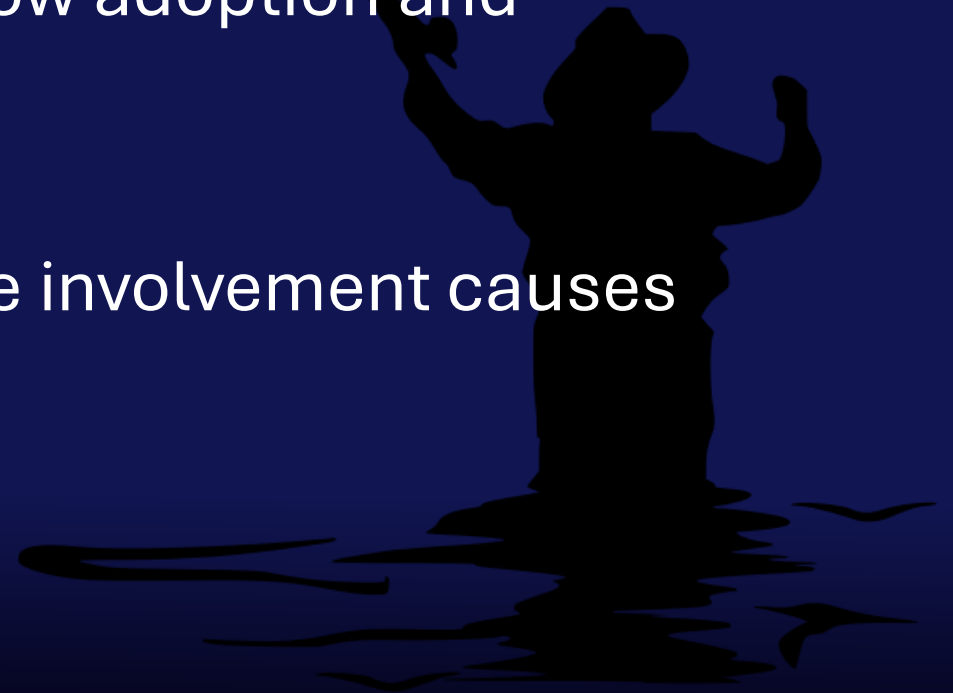
- Sensitivity labels: Define access rules based on data classification
- Integration with Microsoft Information Protection: Enforces encryption and access restrictions

Assume Breach

- Data loss prevention (DLP): Detects and blocks risky data sharing
- Retention & deletion policies: Reduces exposure by managing data lifecycle
- Risk-based insights: Surfaces anomalous behavior tied to sensitive data

Non-Technical Challenges: Where Most Fail

- ♦ Lack of clear data ownership across departments stalls governance
- ♦ Poor stakeholder engagement leads to low adoption and resistance
- ♦ Overreliance on IT without business-side involvement causes disconnect



~~Steakh~~holders Stakeholders

- ◆ Involve management
 - ◆ Compliance
 - ◆ Risk-reduction
 - ◆ Data breach cases
- ◆ Engage stakeholders across the organization to build a unified coalition



Licensing

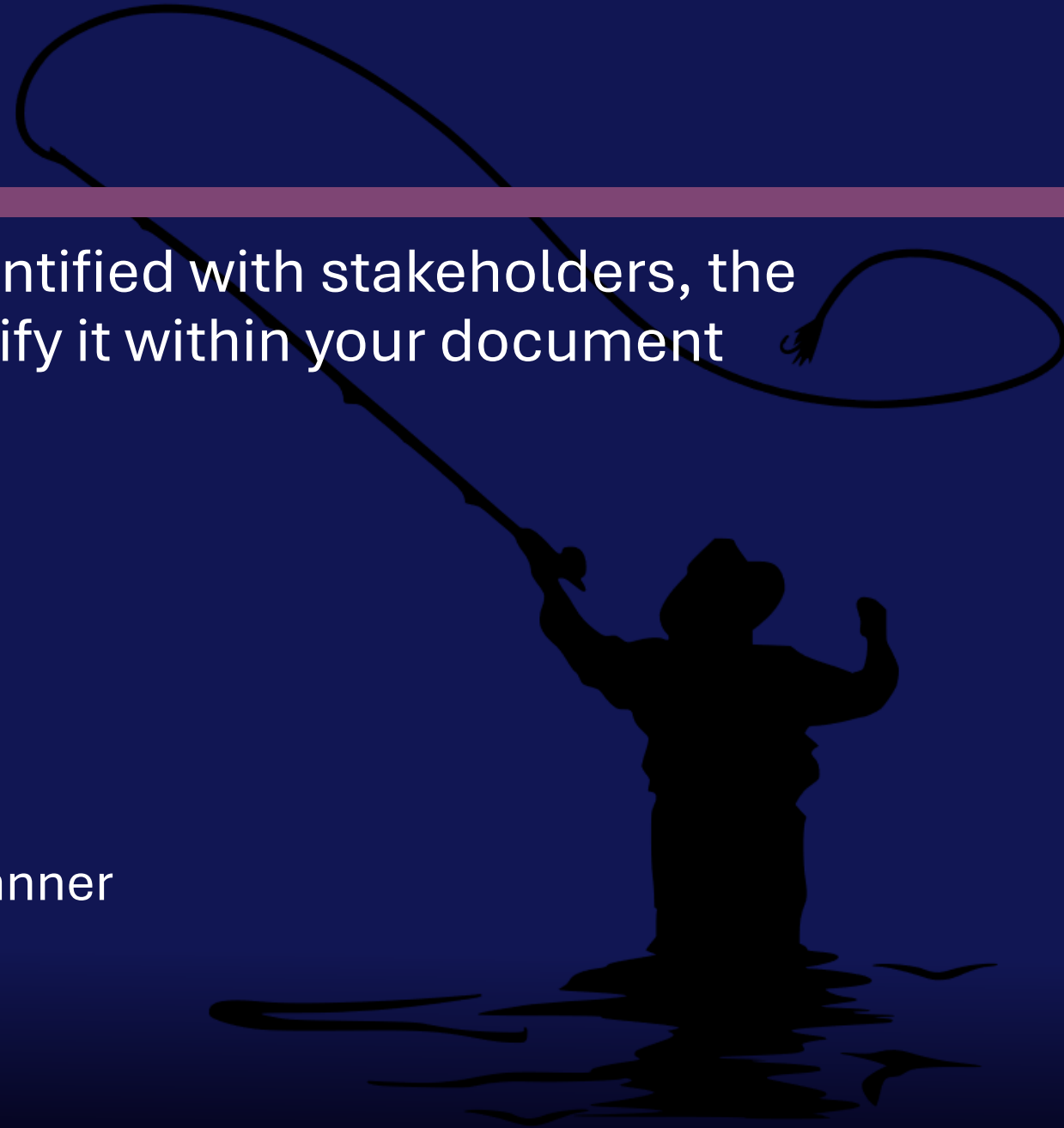
- ◆ Microsoft 365 Licensing
- ◆ Azure Pay-As-You-Go Subscription
- ◆ Third-Party Service Subscriptions

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/office365/servicedescriptions/microsoft-365-service-descriptions/microsoft-365-tenantlevel-services-licensing-guidance/microsoft-purview-service-description>

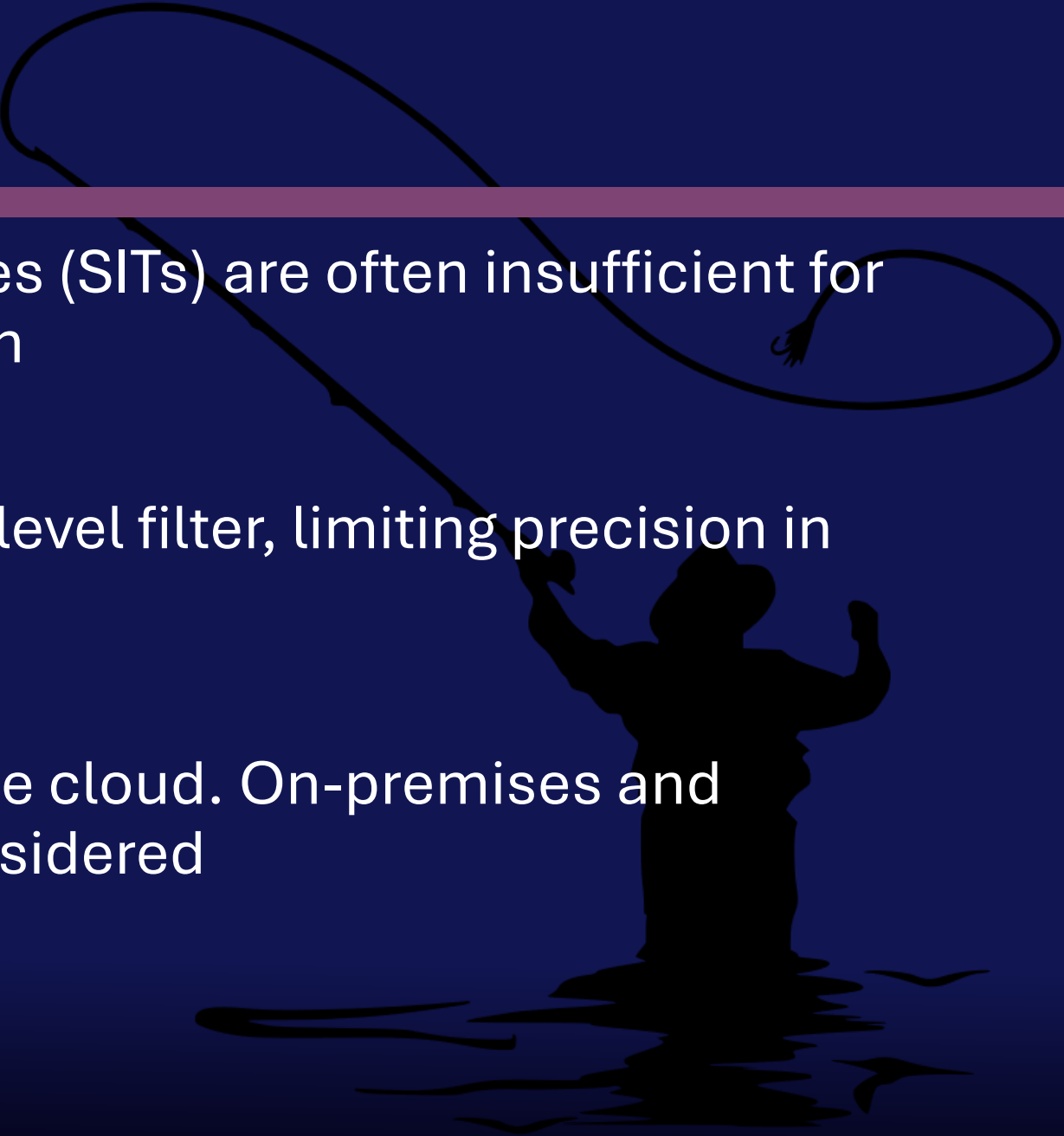


Data Classification

- ◆ Once sensitive data has been identified with stakeholders, the next step is to discover and classify it within your document repositories
- ◆ Tools
 - ◆ Sensitive Information Types
 - ◆ Trainable Classifiers
 - ◆ Data Explorer
 - ◆ Purview Information Protection Scanner



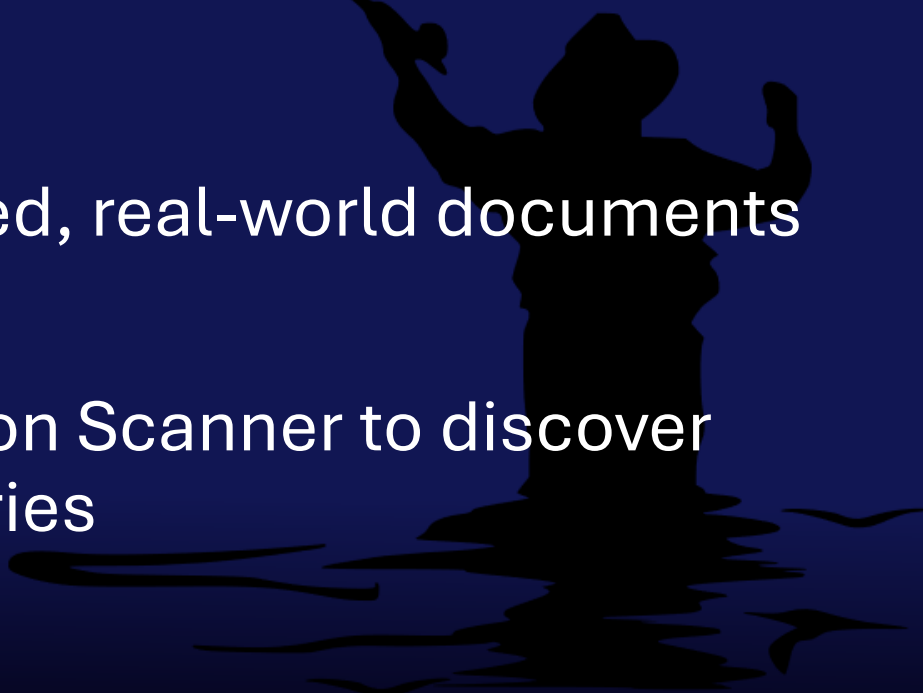
Technical challenges



- ♦ Built-in Sensitive Information Types (SITs) are often insufficient for comprehensive data classification
- ♦ Data Explorer lacks a confidence level filter, limiting precision in results
- ♦ Not all sensitive data resides in the cloud. On-premises and hybrid environments must be considered

Addressing challenges

- ◆ Copy and customize existing Sensitive Information Types (SITs)
- ◆ Create new SITs from scratch using Copilot and Microsoft Learn templates to build regular expressions
- ◆ Train a custom classifier based on labeled, real-world documents
- ◆ Deploy the Purview Information Protection Scanner to discover and label sensitive data across repositories



Labeling and encryption

- ♦ Be cautious with auto-labeling and label priority settings to avoid unintended data restrictions
- ♦ Define exceptions for external users and trusted partners to maintain collaboration without compromising security
- ♦ Verify how encryption policies interact with third-party applications to ensure compatibility and avoid data access issues

Plan for when the original author departs

- ◆ Enable the Super Users feature (recommended to keep it disabled unless strictly necessary)
- ◆ Assign a group of Owners to each sensitivity label for better governance and control
- ◆ Both approaches are compatible with Privileged Identity Management (PIM) for secure, time-bound access

Data Loss Prevention

- ♦ Maintain a balanced approach - avoid making policies overly restrictive
- ♦ Begin in Audit mode without notifying users to collect unbiased usage data. If users don't know they're being monitored, they won't alter their behavior - giving you a true picture of how data is handled
- ♦ Focus on improving user adoption through education, clarity, and gradual rollout

DLP Policies

- ◆ Use assigned or dynamic groups to target policies - assigned groups offer precision, while dynamic groups adapt automatically based on user attributes
- ◆ Avoid duplicate rules and conflicting configurations, as they may increase latency and reduce policy effectiveness
- ◆ Use Sensitive Information Types (SITs) and Trainable Classifiers cautiously together - trainable classifiers have broader detection scopes and may overlap with existing SITs, leading to unintended matches

DLP Policies Inline

- ◆ DLP inline policies can extend data protection controls beyond Microsoft services to include third-party and SaaS applications
- ◆ Applied inline and in real time, meaning content is inspected and evaluated as the user accesses or transfers data
- ◆ DLP inline policies rely on **Microsoft Edge for Business** or **Global Secure Access** to function. These services provide the network and browser-level visibility required to inspect traffic and enforce policies inline

Stop access for AI

- ◆ Microsoft 365 Copilot surfacing content that typical users might not even know exists. Its ability to retrieve hidden information, but also introduces new risks
- ◆ Controlling AI Access & Preventing Data Leakage
 - ◆ Enforce correct permissions to limit access to confidential content
 - ◆ Implement DLP policies for Microsoft 365 Copilot and 3rd-party AI tools (requires PaYG)
 - ◆ Communication Compliance Copilot interactions
 - ◆ Insider Risk Management risky prompts
 - ◆ Block access by category using Microsoft Defender for Endpoint / Entra Internet Access
 - ◆ Enable alerts through Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps to detect risky AI activity

Defender for Cloud Apps

- ◆ Integrates with Purview DLP for several third-party cloud applications
- ◆ Provides native DLP capabilities for OneDrive and SharePoint
- ◆ Supports session control for any Entra-integrated application
 - ◆ Be aware that some third-party apps may lack proper integration with Entra
 - ◆ Desktop applications can bypass session control policies

Retention

- ♦ Retention labels and sensitivity labels are often confused
- ♦ Retention labels and policies do not prevent users from modifying or deleting content, unless the label is configured to mark items as records
- ♦ Dynamic scopes may require Microsoft 365 E5 licensing - even for entities like public folders that typically don't require a license for retention policies

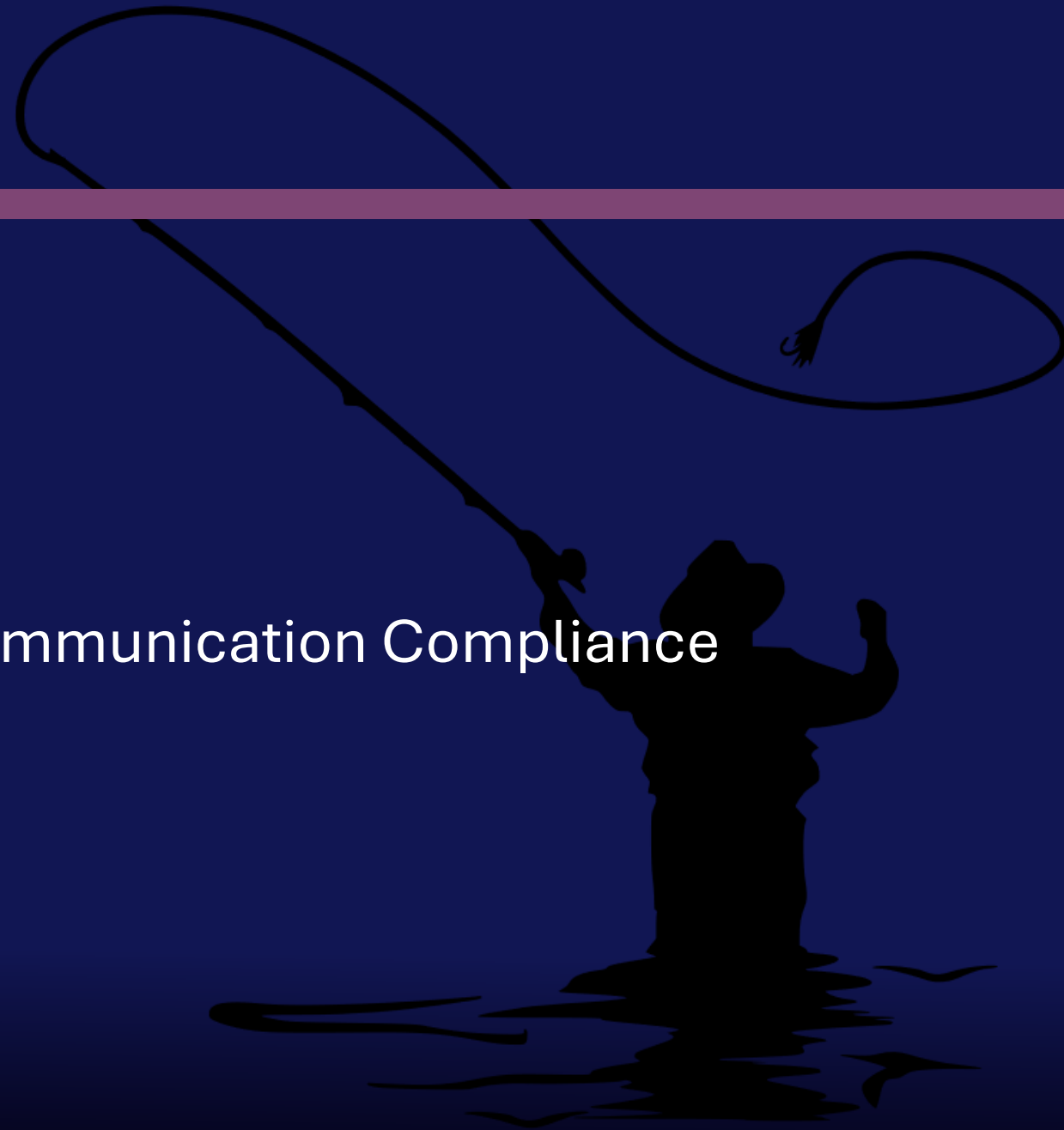
Insider Risk Management and Communication Compliance

- ◆ Available with Microsoft 365 E5 licensing
- ◆ Enhances sensitivity labels and Data Loss Prevention (DLP) policies
- ◆ Operates mostly in the background - does not block user access to content, minimal disruption
- ◆ Enable Adaptive Protection to apply a more restrictive, risk-based approach to data access and policy enforcement.



Conclusion

- ◆ Zero Trust for Data
- ◆ Non-Technical Challenges
- ◆ Data Classification
- ◆ Technical Challenges
- ◆ Insider Risk Management and Communication Compliance



Save the Dates

May 3-7, 2026



Oct 25-28, 2026



May 2-6, 2027



